



ARIZONA COLLEGESM of Nursing

Arizona College of Nursing
NUR 215

Theoretical Foundation in Nursing Practice Student Study Companion

This study companion is designed to help you organize your studying, identify the key concepts for each module, and prepare for classroom learning, clinical experiences, and examinations. It is intended to be used alongside your assigned course materials and class instruction throughout the semester.

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Module 1 – Scope & Practice

Overview

This module introduces the nursing profession and provides the foundation for the rest of the course. As you work through this material, focus on understanding the role of the professional nurse, communication, teamwork, accountability, and patient safety. These concepts provide the foundation for everything that follows in this course.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Understand the role of the registered nurse within today's healthcare system.
- Differentiate scope of practice from standards of practice.
- Become familiar with the Nurse Practice Act and why it is important.
- Review the members of the healthcare team and the importance of collaboration.
- Practice therapeutic communication techniques.
- Begin using basic prioritization and critical thinking skills.
- Recognize the nurse's responsibility for professionalism, accountability, and patient advocacy.

Key Points

- Know the difference between scope of practice (what nurses are legally allowed to do) and standards of practice (how nursing care should be provided).
- Therapeutic communication is a skill that requires practice. Focus on listening, asking open-ended questions, and building trust with patients.
- Safe nursing care begins with good assessment and clear communication.
- Prioritization is introduced early in the course because every nursing decision begins with determining what is most important to address first.

Clinical Pearls

- Always introduce yourself, verify the patient's identity, and explain what you are doing before beginning care.
- Good communication prevents many patient safety events.
- If you are unsure about something, ask for help before acting.
- Professional behavior includes being prepared, respectful, accountable, and willing to continue learning.
- Remember that patients often remember how they were treated just as much as the care they received.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Explain the role of the registered nurse.
- ☐ Describe the purpose of the Nurse Practice Act.
- ☐ Differentiate scope of practice from standards of practice.
- ☐ Identify members of the healthcare team and their roles.
- ☐ Recognize examples of therapeutic communication.
- ☐ Describe the nurse's role in patient advocacy and professional accountability.

Module 2 – Health & Wellness

Overview

Health is more than the absence of disease. Nurses help patients maintain wellness, prevent illness, recognize health risks early, and provide education that supports healthy lifestyles. As you study this module, focus on how nurses promote health across the lifespan while providing individualized, patient-centered care.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Differentiate health promotion from disease prevention.
- Understand primary, secondary, and tertiary prevention.
- Review factors that influence health and wellness.
- Recognize how culture, environment, and lifestyle affect health.
- Understand the nurse's role in patient education.
- Identify age-related differences in health promotion across the lifespan.

Key Points

- Be able to recognize examples of primary, secondary, and tertiary prevention rather than simply memorizing their definitions.
- Remember that health is influenced by physical, emotional, social, cultural, and environmental factors.
- Patient education should be individualized and based on the patient's readiness to learn.
- Nursing care should always consider the patient's values, culture, support system, and available resources.

Clinical Pearls

- Every patient interaction is an opportunity for health promotion.
- Small lifestyle changes can have a significant impact on long-term health.
- Avoid making assumptions about a patient's knowledge or resources.
- Encourage patients to participate in decisions about their own care.
- Teaching is most effective when it is simple, practical, and focused on the patient's immediate needs.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Differentiate health promotion from disease prevention.

- ☐ Identify examples of primary, secondary, and tertiary prevention.
- ☐ Explain factors that influence health and wellness.
- ☐ Describe the nurse's role in patient education.
- ☐ Recognize how health promotion changes across the lifespan.

Module 3 – Infection

Overview

Preventing infection is one of the most important responsibilities of every nurse. This module focuses on how infections develop, how they spread, and the nursing interventions that help protect patients, healthcare workers, and the community. As you study this material, focus on recognizing opportunities to break the chain of infection during everyday patient care.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Learn the six links in the chain of infection.
- Differentiate standard precautions from transmission-based precautions.
- Review appropriate use of personal protective equipment (PPE).
- Understand the difference between medical asepsis and sterile technique.
- Recognize nursing interventions that reduce the risk of healthcare-associated infections.
- Understand the importance of proper hand hygiene.

Key Points

- The easiest way to stop the spread of infection is to break one of the six links in the chain of infection.
- Standard precautions apply to every patient, regardless of diagnosis.
- Know when contact, droplet, and airborne precautions are required and what PPE is appropriate for each.
- Hand hygiene remains one of the simplest and most effective ways to prevent infection.
- When performing sterile procedures, if you are unsure whether an item has been contaminated, consider it contaminated and replace it.

Clinical Pearls

- Clean your hands before and after every patient encounter, even if you wore gloves.
- Gloves do not replace proper hand hygiene.
- Pay attention to isolation signs before entering a patient's room.
- Protect yourself first so you can safely care for your patient.
- Consistently following infection prevention practices protects everyone in the healthcare environment.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Identify the six links in the chain of infection.
- ☐ Differentiate standard precautions from transmission-based precautions.
- ☐ Select the appropriate PPE for common patient situations.
- ☐ Explain the difference between medical asepsis and sterile technique.
- ☐ Describe nursing interventions that help prevent the spread of infection.

Module 4 – Hygiene

Overview

Personal hygiene is an important part of nursing care because it promotes comfort, prevents complications, and provides valuable opportunities to assess the patient's overall condition. As you study this module, focus on recognizing how routine hygiene supports both patient well-being and ongoing nursing assessment.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Review the principles of personal hygiene and patient comfort.
- Understand how hygiene needs change across the lifespan.
- Recognize opportunities to assess patients during routine hygiene care.
- Review oral care, skin care, bathing, and prevention of skin breakdown.
- Understand the importance of privacy, dignity, and patient preferences.
- Recognize findings that should be reported to the healthcare team.

Key Points

- Hygiene is more than completing a task. It is an opportunity to assess the patient's skin, mobility, comfort, and overall condition.
- Pay close attention to bony prominences and areas at risk for pressure injuries.
- Encourage patients to perform as much of their own hygiene as they safely can to promote independence.
- Maintaining privacy and respecting patient preferences are essential parts of providing quality nursing care.
- Early recognition of skin changes can help prevent more serious complications.

Clinical Pearls

- Every bath is also a head-to-toe assessment.
- Protect the patient's dignity by explaining each step before providing care.
- Repositioning patients regularly is one of the best ways to help prevent pressure injuries.
- Oral care is especially important for patients who are unable to care for themselves.
- Report new skin changes, redness, or areas of breakdown promptly.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Explain why hygiene is an important part of nursing care.
- ☐ Identify opportunities to assess patients during hygiene care.
- ☐ Describe interventions that help maintain healthy skin.
- ☐ Explain how nurses help prevent pressure injuries.
- ☐ Recognize assessment findings that should be reported to the healthcare team.

Module 5 – Comfort & Sensory Perception

Overview

Providing comfort is a fundamental part of nursing care. This module focuses on pain, comfort measures, and changes in sensory perception that may affect a patient's safety and quality of life. As you study this material, think about how good assessment guides appropriate nursing interventions and improves patient outcomes.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Differentiate acute pain from chronic pain.
- Review common pain assessment tools and when they are used.
- Understand both medication and non-medication approaches to pain management.
- Recognize factors that influence patient comfort.
- Identify common changes in sensory perception.
- Understand how sensory deficits can affect patient safety.

Key Points

- Pain is subjective. The patient's report is the most reliable indicator of pain.
- A complete pain assessment includes location, quality, severity, duration, and factors that make the pain better or worse.
- Always reassess after any pain intervention to determine if it was effective.
- Comfort involves more than pain control. Positioning, emotional support, rest, and the environment all contribute to patient comfort.
- Sensory changes can increase the risk of falls, injury, and communication difficulties, so modify care to meet the patient's needs.

Clinical Pearls

- Pain should be assessed regularly, not just when a patient requests medication.
- Simple comfort measures such as repositioning or reducing noise can make a significant difference.
- Never assume a patient is comfortable because they appear calm or are not complaining.
- Encourage patients to report pain early before it becomes severe.
- Consider how vision or hearing deficits may affect communication and patient safety.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Differentiate acute pain from chronic pain.
- ☐ Perform an appropriate pain assessment.
- ☐ Identify medication and non-medication pain management strategies.
- ☐ Recognize factors that influence patient comfort.
- ☐ Explain how sensory changes can affect patient safety.

Module 6 – Mobility

Overview

Safe mobility is an essential part of patient care. This module focuses on helping patients move safely while maintaining independence and preventing complications associated with immobility. As you study this material, think about how mobility affects every body system and why early movement is an important part of recovery.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Review the principles of proper body mechanics.
- Understand the effects of immobility on the body.
- Recognize common fall risk factors and prevention strategies.
- Review safe transfer techniques and the use of assistive devices.
- Understand the nurse's role in promoting patient independence.
- Recognize nursing assessments related to mobility and safety.

Key Points

- Before assisting a patient with mobility, always assess strength, balance, level of consciousness, and fall risk.
- Even short periods of immobility can lead to complications such as muscle weakness, pressure injuries, constipation, pneumonia, and blood clots.
- Proper body mechanics help prevent injury to both the patient and the nurse.
- Encourage patients to do as much as they safely can for themselves while providing assistance when needed.
- Fall prevention begins with recognizing patients who are at increased risk and implementing appropriate safety measures.

Clinical Pearls

- Never assume a patient can safely stand or walk without first assessing them.
- Lock beds and wheelchairs before transferring a patient.
- Use assistive devices correctly and ask for help when needed.
- Early mobility improves recovery and reduces complications.
- Protect your own back by using proper lifting techniques every time.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Explain the effects of immobility on the body.
- ☐ Demonstrate proper body mechanics.
- ☐ Identify common fall prevention strategies.
- ☐ Describe safe patient transfer techniques.
- ☐ Explain the purpose of common assistive devices.

Module 7 – Nutrition

Overview

Nutrition plays an important role in growth, healing, recovery, and overall health. This module focuses on assessing nutritional status, promoting healthy eating habits, and recognizing patients who may be at risk for nutritional problems. As you study this material, think about how nutrition affects every aspect of patient care.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Review the components of a nutritional assessment.
- Understand factors that affect nutritional status across the lifespan.
- Become familiar with common therapeutic diets and their purpose.
- Review the nurse's role in promoting adequate nutrition and hydration.
- Recognize patients who may require additional nutritional support.
- Understand the importance of patient education related to nutrition.

Key Points

- A nutritional assessment includes more than weight. Consider appetite, recent weight changes, hydration status, swallowing ability, food preferences, and medical history.
- Poor nutrition can delay healing, increase the risk of infection, and slow recovery.
- Patients have different nutritional needs based on age, medical conditions, activity level, and prescribed diets.
- Encourage adequate hydration unless fluid restrictions have been ordered.
- Nutrition education should be realistic, individualized, and appropriate for the patient's needs and resources.

Clinical Pearls

- Observe how much a patient actually eats rather than assuming they finished their meal.
- Position patients upright before meals to help reduce the risk of aspiration.
- Report poor appetite, difficulty swallowing, or significant weight loss promptly.
- Encourage patients to participate in meal planning whenever possible.
- Good nutrition supports wound healing, immune function, and recovery.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Describe the components of a nutritional assessment.
- ☐ Identify patients who may be at risk for nutritional problems.
- ☐ Recognize common therapeutic diets and their purpose.
- ☐ Explain the nurse's role in promoting nutrition and hydration.
- ☐ Describe basic nutrition education appropriate for different patient populations.

Module 8 – Oxygenation

Overview

Adequate oxygenation is essential for every body system. This module focuses on respiratory assessment, recognizing early signs of respiratory compromise, and the nursing interventions used to maintain a patent airway and support effective breathing. As you study this material, focus on connecting assessment findings with appropriate nursing actions.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Review normal respiratory assessment findings.
- Recognize signs and symptoms of impaired oxygenation.
- Become familiar with common oxygen delivery devices.
- Review nursing interventions that promote airway clearance.
- Understand the importance of ongoing respiratory assessment.
- Identify assessment findings that require prompt intervention.

Key Points

- A complete respiratory assessment includes respiratory rate, work of breathing, lung sounds, oxygen saturation, skin color, and mental status.
- Oxygen saturation should always be interpreted alongside your patient assessment.
- Always consider the patient's overall condition and assessment findings.
- Learn the basic uses of common oxygen delivery devices and when each may be appropriate.
- Encourage coughing, deep breathing, and incentive spirometry when appropriate to help prevent postoperative respiratory complications.
- Changes in respiratory status often occur before changes in heart rate or blood pressure, making early assessment especially important.

Clinical Pearls

- Count respirations before telling the patient you are assessing them to avoid changing their breathing pattern.
- Increasing work of breathing is often one of the earliest signs that a patient is getting worse.
- Positioning a patient upright can often improve breathing and comfort.
- Compare each respiratory assessment with previous findings to recognize trends.

- Report new or worsening shortness of breath, abnormal lung sounds, or changes in mental status promptly.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Perform a basic respiratory assessment.
- ☐ Recognize signs of impaired oxygenation.
- ☐ Identify common oxygen delivery devices.
- ☐ Describe nursing interventions that promote airway clearance.
- ☐ Explain the purpose of incentive spirometry.
- ☐ Recognize assessment findings that require prompt nursing intervention.

Module 9 – Medication Administration

Overview

Safe medication administration is one of the nurse's most important responsibilities. This module focuses on preventing medication errors, applying safe medication practices, performing accurate dosage calculations, and understanding the nurse's role before, during, and after administering medications. These concepts will continue to build throughout the nursing program and clinical experiences.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Review the rights of medication administration.
- Practice dosage calculations until you can complete them accurately and confidently.
- Understand the different routes of medication administration.
- Review nursing responsibilities before, during, and after medication administration.
- Understand safe medication documentation.
- Recognize situations that require clarification before administering a medication.

Key Points

- Safe medication administration begins with a thorough patient assessment, not with opening the medication package.
- Always use at least two patient identifiers and verify allergies before administering medications.
- Know the purpose of the medication, expected effects, common side effects, and any assessments required before administration.
- If an order seems unclear, incomplete, or unsafe, stop and clarify it before giving the medication.
- Develop a consistent routine when administering medications. Following the same process every time helps reduce medication errors.

Clinical Pearls

- Never allow yourself to be rushed while preparing or administering medications.
- Read every medication label carefully, even if you have given the medication many times before.
- Patients have the right to ask questions and to refuse medications.

- Document medications according to facility policy immediately after administration.
- Always reassess your patient after medications that require evaluation, such as pain medications or medications that affect blood pressure or blood glucose.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Describe the rights of medication administration.
- ☐ Complete basic dosage calculations accurately.
- ☐ Identify common routes of medication administration.
- ☐ Explain nursing responsibilities before, during, and after medication administration.
- ☐ Recognize situations that require clarification before administering a medication.
- ☐ Describe strategies that help prevent medication errors.

Module 10 – Rest and Sleep

Overview

Rest and sleep are essential for healing, physical recovery, emotional well-being, and overall health. Illness, hospitalization, pain, anxiety, and changes in routine can all interfere with normal sleep patterns. As you study this module, focus on identifying factors that affect sleep and the nursing interventions that promote rest and recovery.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Review the stages of sleep and their purpose.
- Understand factors that interfere with normal sleep patterns.
- Recognize signs and symptoms of sleep deprivation.
- Review nursing interventions that promote rest and sleep.
- Understand how hospitalization affects normal sleep routines.
- Recognize the relationship between sleep, healing, and overall health.

Key Points

- Sleep is an important part of healing and should be considered during every patient assessment.
- Before implementing interventions, identify why the patient is not sleeping. Pain, anxiety, medications, noise, and frequent interruptions are common causes.
- Nursing interventions do not always require medication. Simple measures such as reducing noise, dimming lights, clustering care, and promoting comfort can improve sleep quality.
- Fatigue is different from normal tiredness and may indicate an underlying health problem that requires further assessment.
- Sleep needs vary throughout the lifespan, so compare the patient's current sleep pattern with their normal routine.

Clinical Pearls

- Pain control often improves sleep quality.
- Whenever possible, organize care to reduce unnecessary interruptions during rest periods.
- Ask patients about their normal bedtime routine and try to maintain it when appropriate.
- A well-rested patient is often better able to participate in therapy, education, and recovery.
- Changes in sleep patterns may be one of the first signs that a patient is experiencing physical or emotional distress.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Identify factors that affect sleep and rest.
- ☐ Recognize signs of sleep deprivation.
- ☐ Describe nursing interventions that promote restful sleep.
- ☐ Explain the difference between fatigue and normal tiredness.
- ☐ Describe how hospitalization can affect normal sleep patterns.

Module 11 – Stress and Coping

Overview

Stress is a normal part of life, but each person responds to stress differently. Nurses must be able to recognize healthy and unhealthy coping strategies, assess how stress affects physical and emotional health, and provide support that promotes positive coping. As you study this module, focus on understanding how stress influences patient care across the lifespan.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Differentiate stress from stressors.
- Review common physical, emotional, and behavioral responses to stress.
- Recognize healthy and unhealthy coping strategies.
- Understand the nurse's role in supporting patients experiencing stress.
- Identify factors that influence an individual's response to stress.
- Recognize situations that may require additional emotional support or referral.

Key Points

- Every patient experiences stress differently. Avoid assuming that two patients will respond the same way to a similar situation.
- Stress can affect both physical and emotional health and may influence healing, sleep, pain, communication, and decision-making.
- Coping strategies may be healthy or unhealthy. Focus on helping patients develop positive coping skills that support recovery.
- Assess not only the source of stress but also the patient's available support system and current coping methods.
- Therapeutic communication is one of the most effective nursing interventions for patients experiencing stress.

Clinical Pearls

- Sometimes the most helpful nursing intervention is simply listening without interrupting.
- Patients experiencing stress may have difficulty remembering information, so provide education in small amounts and reinforce important points.
- Encourage patients to identify healthy coping strategies that have worked for them in the past.
- Involve family or support persons when appropriate and desired by the patient.

- Report significant changes in mood, behavior, or coping ability to the healthcare team.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Differentiate stress from stressors.
- ☐ Identify common physical and emotional responses to stress.
- ☐ Recognize healthy and unhealthy coping strategies.
- ☐ Explain the nurse's role in supporting patients experiencing stress.
- ☐ Describe interventions that promote positive coping and emotional well-being.

Module 12 – Loss, Grief, and End-of-Life Care

Overview

Nurses care for patients and families experiencing loss in many different forms, including changes in health, independence, relationships, and life itself. This module focuses on recognizing normal grief responses, providing compassionate care, and supporting patients and families through difficult situations. As you study this material, remember that every person's experience with loss is unique.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Differentiate the types of loss and grief.
- Review common emotional responses to grief.
- Understand the nurse's role in supporting grieving patients and families.
- Recognize therapeutic communication techniques during difficult conversations.
- Understand the principles of end-of-life care.
- Recognize the importance of respecting cultural, spiritual, and personal beliefs.

Key Points

- There is no "right" way to grieve. Each patient and family responds differently based on their experiences, beliefs, and support systems.
- Therapeutic communication often involves listening more than talking. Avoid giving false reassurance or trying to "fix" a patient's emotions.
- End-of-life nursing care focuses on comfort, dignity, symptom management, and supporting both the patient and family.
- Cultural and spiritual beliefs often influence decisions about illness, death, and mourning. Always ask rather than assume.
- Families may need education and emotional support throughout the grieving process, not just after a death occurs.

Clinical Pearls

- Sometimes your presence is more valuable than your words.
- Allow patients and families time to express emotions without feeling rushed.
- Use therapeutic silence when appropriate.
- Respect individual beliefs and preferences regarding end-of-life care.
- Provide privacy whenever possible during emotionally difficult situations.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Differentiate common types of loss and grief.
- ☐ Identify therapeutic communication techniques used with grieving patients.
- ☐ Describe the nurse's role in providing end-of-life care.
- ☐ Explain why cultural and spiritual beliefs should be considered during patient care.
- ☐ Recognize nursing interventions that promote comfort, dignity, and family support.

Module 13 – Documentation and Informatics

Overview

Accurate documentation and effective communication are essential parts of safe nursing practice. This module focuses on documenting patient care clearly, communicating with the healthcare team, and using electronic health records appropriately. As you study this material, remember that documentation is both a communication tool and a legal record of the care you provide.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Review the principles of accurate nursing documentation.
- Understand the legal importance of documentation.
- Become familiar with electronic health records.
- Review effective communication among members of the healthcare team.
- Understand the importance of patient confidentiality.
- Recognize documentation practices that improve patient safety.

Key Points

- Documentation should always be accurate, objective, complete, and completed as soon as possible after providing care.
- Document what you observe, what you do, and how the patient responds. Avoid opinions or assumptions.
- Protect patient confidentiality by following HIPAA requirements and your facility's privacy policies.
- Electronic health records improve communication, but only if documentation is complete and accurate.
- Prompt communication of significant changes in patient condition is just as important as documenting them.

Clinical Pearls

- If it wasn't documented, it may be difficult to demonstrate that it was done.
- Chart objective findings instead of personal opinions.
- Review your documentation before signing it.
- Never document care before it has actually been provided.
- Good documentation supports continuity of care and improves patient safety.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Describe the characteristics of accurate nursing documentation.
- ☐ Explain why documentation is considered a legal record.
- ☐ Identify examples of objective documentation.
- ☐ Describe how nurses protect patient confidentiality.
- ☐ Explain the importance of communicating significant patient changes promptly.

Module 14 – Perioperative Nursing Care

Overview

Perioperative nursing focuses on providing safe, patient-centered care before, during, and after surgery. Nurses play an important role in preparing patients for surgery, preventing complications, monitoring recovery, and providing education for a safe discharge. As you study this module, focus on understanding the nurse's responsibilities during each phase of the surgical experience.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Differentiate the preoperative, intraoperative, and postoperative phases of surgery.
- Review preoperative nursing assessments and patient education.
- Recognize common postoperative complications.
- Understand nursing interventions that promote recovery.
- Review pain management principles following surgery.
- Identify assessment findings that require prompt intervention.

Key Points

- The preoperative phase includes patient assessment, education, and preparation for surgery. Verify required documentation and report any concerns before the procedure begins.
- Postoperative care focuses on airway, breathing, circulation, pain management, neurological status, and early recognition of complications.
- Early ambulation, coughing and deep breathing, incentive spirometry, and adequate pain control all help reduce postoperative complications.
- Continue reassessing the patient throughout recovery. Compare new findings with previous assessments and report unexpected changes promptly.
- Patient education before discharge should include activity restrictions, incision care, medications, follow-up appointments, and when to seek medical attention.

Clinical Pearls

- Airway and breathing are always the highest priorities immediately after surgery.
- Good pain control helps patients participate in deep breathing, mobility, and recovery.
- Encourage early mobility as soon as it is safe to do so.
- Small changes in vital signs or mental status may be early signs of a developing complication.

- Reinforce discharge instructions and encourage patients to ask questions before leaving the hospital.

Before Moving On

Before class, make sure you can:

- ☐ Differentiate the three phases of perioperative nursing care.
- ☐ Describe the nurse's responsibilities before and after surgery.
- ☐ Recognize common postoperative complications.
- ☐ Explain interventions that promote recovery after surgery.
- ☐ Identify assessment findings that require prompt nursing intervention.

Module 15 – Comprehensive Review

Overview

This final module is designed to help you bring together the concepts you've learned throughout NUR 215. Rather than trying to memorize isolated facts, focus on making connections between assessment findings, nursing interventions, patient safety, and clinical judgment. Use this module to identify areas that need additional review before the final exam.

Required Resources

Refer to the course syllabus for the assigned textbook readings, videos, learning activities, and other required resources for this module.

Focus Your Studying

- Review major concepts from each previous module.
- Connect assessment findings with appropriate nursing interventions.
- Continue practicing dosage calculations.
- Review infection prevention and patient safety principles.
- Practice applying the nursing process to patient scenarios.
- Identify areas that need additional review before the final examination.

Key Points

- Focus on understanding concepts rather than memorizing isolated facts. Many exam questions require you to apply what you have learned.
- Review the nursing process and think through patient scenarios by asking yourself what assessment findings are most important and what nursing action should be taken first.
- Prioritization is a common theme throughout nursing. Practice identifying the highest-priority patient and the most appropriate first intervention.
- Review safety concepts from every module, including medication safety, infection prevention, fall prevention, communication, and documentation.
- As you review, connect topics together. For example, poor nutrition can delay wound healing, pain can affect mobility, and impaired mobility increases the risk of pressure injuries.

Clinical Pearls

- Read every exam question carefully before selecting an answer.
- Look for assessment data before choosing an intervention.
- Patient safety should guide every nursing decision.
- If two answer choices seem correct, think about which action should be performed first.
- Review areas you find challenging before spending extra time on topics you already know well.

Before Moving On

Before taking the final exam, make sure you can:

- ☐ Apply the nursing process to common patient situations.
- ☐ Prioritize nursing care using clinical judgment.
- ☐ Recognize assessment findings that require immediate intervention.
- ☐ Explain the rationale for common nursing interventions.
- ☐ Demonstrate an understanding of patient safety principles across all course topics.
- ☐ Identify any topics that require additional review before the final examination.

General Study Tips

- Stay current with the assigned readings and learning activities. Nursing concepts build on one another throughout the semester.
- Review material a little each day instead of waiting until just before an exam.
- Focus on understanding why nursing interventions are performed, not just memorizing facts.
- Practice applying concepts to patient scenarios whenever possible.
- Ask questions during class if you are unsure about a concept. Clarifying confusion early will make future modules easier.
- Review your notes after class while the material is still fresh.
- Continue practicing dosage calculations throughout the semester, even after the medication administration module.

Tips for NCLEX-Style Questions

As you prepare for quizzes and exams, remember to:

- Read the entire question before looking at the answer choices.
- Identify exactly what the question is asking.
- Look for assessment findings before choosing an intervention.
- Think about patient safety first.
- Consider priorities using Airway, Breathing, Circulation (ABC), safety, and the nursing process.
- If two answers seem correct, determine which action should be completed first.

Building Clinical Judgment

Throughout this course, begin asking yourself these questions whenever you study a patient scenario:

- What is my priority assessment?
- What information is most important?
- What problem is the patient experiencing?
- What nursing intervention should I perform first?
- How will I know if my intervention was effective?

Developing this thought process now will make future nursing courses, simulation, clinical experiences, and NCLEX preparation much easier.